WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

EQUATORIAL GUINEA

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Ciudad de la Paz (Djibloho)	New political capital on the mainland since a presidential decree of 2 January 2026, with the presidency, ministries and public bodies relocating in stages	Construction, public services, real estate, hospitality
Malabo (Bioko Island)	Capital from independence in 1968 until 2026 and still the country's principal economic and business centre	Financial services, hospitality, professional and oilfield services
Punta Europa (Bioko Island)	Gas processing complex at the heart of the Gas Mega Hub, including an LNG export terminal operating since 2007, an LPG plant, a methanol facility and a power station	LNG, gas processing, petrochemicals, power
Offshore Blocks I and O (Aseng and Alen)	Chevron took a $690 million final investment decision on the Aseng gas project in 2026, with first gas expected in 2028 to lift feed gas to Punta Europa from about 175 to over 300 mmcfd	Upstream gas, subsea engineering, oilfield services
Yoyo-Yolanda (maritime border with Cameroon)	Cross-border gas resource of an estimated 2.5 trillion cubic feet, unitised with Cameroon in February 2026, with first gas targeted for late 2029	Cross-border gas, pipelines, regional energy integration
Block EG-27 (Ebano)	Around 3 tcf of contingent gas resources, wholly owned by the national gas company SONAGAS, with ConocoPhillips having signed a Heads of Agreement to participate	Gas development, LNG backfill, infrastructure
Bata (Litoral)	Largest mainland city and port, and the commercial gateway to the mainland region and the new capital	Port logistics, trade, construction, agro-processing

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Ventanilla Única Empresarial (VUE), the one-stop shop for business incorporation, linked to labour and social-security registration, with minimum capital requirements cut by 90% and procedures and fees published online by the Ministry of Finance

- Investment Law No. 7/1992 (amended by Law No. 2/1994), guaranteeing fair and equitable treatment, compensation for expropriation in convertible currency, transfer of net dividends and liquidation proceeds, and access to international (UNCITRAL) arbitration
- OHADA uniform business law, of which Equatorial Guinea is a founding member, governing company, commercial and insolvency matters on a harmonised regional basis
- CFA franc (XAF) pegged to the euro, with foreign-exchange and capital transfers governed by CEMAC regulations and the Bank of Central African States (BEAC)
- Production-sharing contracts with the Ministry of Hydrocarbons and Mining Development, with participation by the national companies GEPetrol and SONAGAS, and a new licensing round announced for 2026
- Decree No. 100/2024, setting mandatory procedural steps and defined timeframes before any judgment can be enforced against petroleum-sector assets, strengthening legal certainty for oil and gas investors
- Gas Mega Hub access, under which third-party and cross-border gas, including from Cameroon and potentially Nigeria, can be processed through existing Punta Europa infrastructure

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Equatorial Guinea in October 2026 is in an active phase of economic adjustment and gas-led renewal, underpinned by price stability and a disciplined reform programme. The non-hydrocarbon economy grew 2.3% in 2025 and is projected by the IMF to keep expanding by around 2–3% a year, while inflation eased to 2.6% in October 2025, well inside the CEMAC 3% ceiling, and the regional central bank cut its policy rate to 4.5% in June 2026, a level it held in September. Public debt stood at a moderate 39.2% of GDP at end-2025, with the authorities committed to keeping it below 50%. Under an IMF Staff-Monitored Programme, extended in June 2025, the government has met its fiscal targets, enacted a broader tax law, approved a public procurement law (November 2025) and seen its financial intelligence unit join the Egmont Group (July 2025). Investor commitment is visible in the energy sector: Chevron took a $690 million final investment decision on the Aseng gas project in 2026, and the state raised GEPetrol's stake in the project from 5% to 32.55%.

The country's main structural challenge is the natural maturing of its oil and gas fields. Total hydrocarbon output fell from 81.0 million to 67.2 million barrels of oil equivalent between 2024 and 2025, and real GDP contracted 6.4% in 2025, with the IMF projecting a further 2.7% decline in 2026 before new gas comes on stream. The government's response is the Gas Mega Hub, which uses existing Punta Europa infrastructure to monetise gas that would otherwise remain stranded: Aseng first gas is expected in 2028, the Yoyo-Yolanda field shared with Cameroon was unitised in February 2026 with first gas targeted for late 2029, and the three hub phases are expected to commercialise about 1 trillion cubic feet over the next decade, with nearly 2 tcf of further backfill and around 3 tcf in Block EG-27. This positions Equatorial Guinea as a regional gas-processing centre for the Gulf of Guinea, while the relocation of the capital to Ciudad de la Paz and IMF-backed reforms create openings in construction, services and economic diversification.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Maturing hydrocarbon fields	Hydrocarbon output fell about 17% in 2025 and GDP contracted 6.4%, with a further decline projected for 2026 before new gas volumes arrive	Aseng (2028) and Yoyo-Yolanda (late 2029) will restore feed gas to Punta Europa, creating near-term opportunities in drilling, subsea and processing services
Economic concentration in oil and gas	Hydrocarbons still generate most government revenue, while the non-hydrocarbon economy is growing steadily at around 2–3% a year	Diversification priorities and the new capital's build-out open space for investors in construction, services, agriculture and logistics
Governance and transparency	Reforms are advancing under the IMF programme, including a procurement law and Egmont Group membership, although officials' asset declarations have not yet been published	Apply enhanced due diligence, politically exposed person screening and sanctions checks on counterparties, and use contracts with international arbitration clauses
Government payment arrears and bank balance sheets	The state has begun clearing domestic arrears to banks, with its clearance plan awaiting approval by the regional	Structure payment security through escrow, offshore accounts or DFI participation; arrears clearance will

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	supervisor COBAC; non-performing loans remain high	progressively improve local liquidity
Changes to the incentive regime	In February 2025 the government suspended tax exemptions previously available to non-oil companies under the Investment Law	Negotiate project-specific terms and stability provisions at the outset; a broader tax base supports the fiscal sustainability that investors rely on
Local ownership and administrative procedures	Company formation has historically required national shareholders holding at least 35% of capital, alongside multi-agency approvals	Confirm current requirements with local counsel; the VUE one-stop shop and lower minimum capital have simplified incorporation
Foreign-exchange and repatriation procedures	Transfers are governed by CEMAC exchange regulations, and Equatorial Guinea's contribution to regional reserves has been negative in recent years	The euro peg gives currency stability; build BEAC transfer approvals into project timelines and agree repatriation mechanics early

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Equatorial Guinea's risk profile reflects a hydrocarbon economy managing the natural maturing of its fields through a credible gas strategy and a structured reform programme. Price stability within the euro-pegged CFA franc zone, moderate public debt of 39.2% of GDP and a strong record of meeting IMF fiscal targets provide a stable base, while the $690 million Aseng investment, the unitisation of Yoyo-Yolanda with Cameroon and new interest in Block EG-27 show international operators committing capital to the Gas Mega Hub. The contraction of 2025–26 is linked to production decline rather than to policy, and new gas volumes from 2028 are expected to sustain LNG exports into the mid-2030s. Governance remains the main area for investor attention: reforms such as the procurement law, Egmont Group membership and the planned hydrocarbon transparency report are welcome progress, and investors should apply enhanced due diligence, politically exposed person and sanctions screening, and robust contractual and payment protections. With these measures in place, the hub's expansion offers a clear long-term opportunity in gas, services and infrastructure.

MARKET ACCESS

Equatorial Guinea is a member of the Central African Economic and Monetary Community (CEMAC), sharing a customs union, a common central bank (BEAC) and the euro-pegged CFA franc with Cameroon, Gabon, the Republic of Congo, Chad and the Central African Republic, and it applies OHADA's harmonised business law. It has been a member of OPEC since 2017. Crude oil and LNG are shipped to international markets from offshore terminals and from Punta Europa, where the LNG plant has operated since 2007. The country's strategic advantage is its role as a gas-processing gateway for the Gulf of Guinea: the Gas Mega Hub can aggregate gas from neighbouring Cameroon, which holds more than 6 tcf of largely stranded gas, and a 2024 treaty with Nigeria supports a proposed Gulf of Guinea Gas Pipeline of up to 2,700 mmcfd. This regional positioning gives investors access to a growing cross-border energy market as well as to the wider CEMAC zone.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Teodoro Obiang Nguema Mbasogo)	Sets national strategy, including the Gas Mega Hub and the 2026 relocation of the capital to Ciudad de la Paz; the Vice-President oversees the transfer of administrations	Primary reference point for understanding Equatorial Guinea's strategic direction
Ministry of Hydrocarbons and Mining Development (Minister Antonio Oburu Ondo)	Leads licensing, production-sharing contracts and the Gas Mega Hub, including the Aseng and Yoyo-Yolanda agreements	Essential counterpart for any energy, mining or energy-services engagement
Ministry of Finance and the Ventanilla Única Empresarial (VUE)	Leads fiscal policy and the IMF programme, and hosts the one-stop shop	First point of contact for company set-up, tax and non-energy investment

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	for business registration	
Bank of Central African States (BEAC) and COBAC	Regional central bank managing the CFA franc, CEMAC exchange regulations and foreign-currency transfers; COBAC supervises banks	Relevant for repatriation, financing and banking-sector matters
GEPetrol (national oil company)	State partner in production-sharing contracts, now holding 32.55% of the Aseng gas project	Key partner for upstream participation and joint ventures
SONAGAS (national gas company)	State gas company and sole owner of Block EG-27 (Ebano), with around 3 tcf of contingent resources	Key counterpart for gas development, midstream and Gas Mega Hub opportunities
IMF and World Bank country teams	Support the Staff-Monitored Programme and the business-climate reform agenda, including governance and transparency commitments	Useful reference for tracking reform progress and the outlook for the investment climate

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Ministry of Hydrocarbons and Mining Development is the main convening body for the energy sector, and its licensing rounds and project signings are the principal occasions for engagement with government and the national companies GEPetrol and SONAGAS. International operators active in the Gas Mega Hub, led by Chevron as operator of Blocks I and O, maintain a substantial in-country presence and are a valuable source of practical intelligence on logistics and contracting. The Africa Energy Chamber regularly covers and promotes Equatorial Guinea's gas strategy, and the IMF and World Bank publish regular assessments of the reform programme and business climate. For non-energy investors, the VUE one-stop shop and the regional institutions of CEMAC and BEAC are the main channels for company set-up and cross-border operations.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Equatorial Guinea best suits investors with experience of resource-based frontier markets and a long-term horizon: upstream gas companies and oilfield, drilling and subsea service providers positioned for the Aseng, Yoyo-Yolanda and EG-27 developments; midstream, LNG, power and petrochemical investors drawn by the Punta Europa complex and its role as a regional gas hub; and construction, engineering and real-estate firms targeting the build-out of Ciudad de la Paz. Investors in services, agriculture and logistics can find openings in the government's diversification agenda, and all investors benefit from structuring with strong due diligence, payment security and international arbitration provisions.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage the Ministry of Hydrocarbons and Mining Development on the Gas Mega Hub
Open dialogue on the 2026 licensing round, Aseng and Yoyo-Yolanda supply-chain needs, and partnership opportunities with GEPetrol and SONAGAS.

STEP 2: Commission enhanced due diligence before committing capital
Carry out counterparty, politically exposed person and sanctions screening, and secure contracts with stability clauses and international arbitration.

STEP 3: Agree repatriation and payment mechanics early
Work with banks and counsel on CEMAC exchange approvals, escrow or offshore payment structures, and exposure to government arrears.

STEP 4: Track IMF programme milestones and governance reforms
Follow the hydrocarbon transparency report, arrears clearance and banking reforms as indicators of an improving investment climate.

STEP 5: Assess opportunities in Ciudad de la Paz and diversification sectors
Use the VUE one-stop shop and local counsel to evaluate construction, services and logistics projects linked to the new capital and the mainland economy.